

St Pats Nursery Programme – Mentor Summary

Our Purpose

The St Pats Nursery Programme introduces children aged 4–6 to Gaelic Games in a **fun, safe and engaging environment** that builds confidence, movement skills, enjoyment of sport, and a lifelong connection with St Pats.

Our guiding principle is simple:

Children play sport because it is fun.

Everything we do should reflect that.

Our Coaching Philosophy

The Nursery focuses on developing **Physical Literacy** — helping children learn how to move confidently and competently so that they can enjoy a lifelong involvement in Sports.

This means building:

- **Physical Competence** – movement skills and sporting skills
- **Confidence & Motivation** – helping children feel capable and enjoy participation
- **Knowledge & Understanding** – creating positive habits around activity and sport

The objective is:

“As many as we can, for as long as we can.”

What We Coach

The Nursery sits within the **GAA Foundation 1 (F1) Player Pathway**, with an emphasis on fundamental movement and early game skills.



Core Skill Areas



The aim is to create children who are:

- confident movers
- enthusiastic participants

Understanding 4–6 Year Olds

Children in this age group:

- have short attention spans
- are still learning cooperation
- often focus only on the ball
- respond best to games, races and fun challenges
- learn through demonstration, repetition and encouragement

Coaching should therefore be:

- active
- simple
- energetic
- positive
- game-based

The St Pats Coaching Approach

All nursery mentors should follow our coaching model:



Mentor Expectations

All mentors are expected to:

- Complete **Garda Vetting**
- Complete **GAA Child Safeguarding**
- Support a safe, inclusive environment
- Follow the coaching plan
- Help with set-up and clean-up
- Encourage effort, fun and participation for every child

Nursery Rules We Reinforce

Children should learn to:

- Be on time
- Respect equipment
- Give their best effort
- Be kind to others
- Encourage teammates
- Play fairly
- Have fun

Final Reminder

At nursery level, **we are not coaching winning teams — we are developing happy, confident children who love Gaelic Games.**

Fun first. Movement & Skills second, Development always.